

Student: Excuse me. Is there any chance of getting an extension for this essay?

Tutor: This isn't the first time you've asked for an extension.

Student: I realise that it would be inconvenient, but I really did everything I could to get hold of the book.

Tutor: But it's a question of fairness.

Student: I know I have already had an extension, but the book was borrowed by another student.

Tutor: I have to think about the other students.

Student: I asked for the book to be recalled, but it came back only yesterday.

Tutor: You should have had plenty of time to plan for this.

Student: I did plan, but I had to wait for this one specific book on my home country.

Tutor: Why didn't you come to tell me about this earlier?

Student: I thought the book would come back sooner.

Tutor: You know the deadline is 5 p.m. tomorrow.

Student: Yes, I know. But I need time to read and analyse the information in the book.

Tutor: I have to do all the marking this weekend.

Student: I understand. But I think I will need at least another two days.

Tutor: Next week I am running a one-day conference.

Student: I should be able to finish the essay by Sunday.

Tutor: That will make it difficult for me to accept a late essay.

Student: I really did everything I could.

Tutor: This student-work situation is not easy.

Student: Is there any chance of extending the deadline to Monday?

Tutor: I have to think about the other students and their deadlines.

Student: I only need a little more time.

Tutor: But you have already had one extension earlier this term.

Student: Yes, but that time I was ill.

Tutor: And you sometimes miss lectures and come in late to others.

Student: I know, but I worked hard on this essay.

Tutor: I have my own rule. If an essay comes in late without a good reason, I take 10% off the final mark.

Student: I realise that it would be inconvenient.

Tutor: It is difficult for me to change the deadline unless there are exceptional reasons.

Student: Waiting for the book was a real problem for me.

Tutor: But other students also have problems and still meet the deadline.

Student: I really did everything I could to get hold of it.

Tutor: I understand, but I must be fair.

Student: I am just asking for this small extension.

Tutor: I will think about it.

Student: Thank you. I appreciate that.

Tutor: If I do allow it, it will be only until Monday.

Student: That will help me finish properly.

Tutor: But if I decide not to extend the deadline, you must hand it in by tomorrow at 5 p.m.

Student: I understand.

Tutor: And if you hand it in late without approval, I will take 10% off the final mark.

Student: Yes, I know.

Tutor: I will let you know my final decision soon.

Student: Thank you again.

D-2

Student: I'm sorry to bother you, but I wanted to ask about the evening English courses.

Director: The problem is that your scores are over 60%, so you cannot be accepted automatically.

Student: I'm a bit worried about my English. Everyone else on my course is a native speaker, so I really don't feel that my level is good enough.

Director: Have you any reason to think you have serious language problems?

Student: After all, I only got just over 60. My listening was 61%, my reading was 68%, and my writing was 63%. My average was 64%. I know this is above IELTS 6.5, but I still feel worried.

Director: We have to give priority to students with less than satisfactory scores.

Student: I understand, but when I did IELTS before coming here, I only got 6.0. That was the minimum score. Since arriving at the university, I feel at a disadvantage.

Director: The problem is that many students want places this year. There is greater demand than ever before.

Student: I really don't feel that my English is good enough. Why can't I have a place?

Director: We have to give priority to students who scored below 60% or who have a section score under 60%.

Student: I know, but I want to keep up with the native speakers. I want to understand lectures better, read faster, and write better essays.

Director: I understand your worry, but your scores are not low. They are all above 60%.

Student: But I am used to getting 80% or more in my home country. Here the subjects are harder, and I feel I need extra help.

Director: I see. The problem is that we must follow the rules. Higher-scoring students go on the waiting list.

Student: So what can I do?

Director: Instead of coming to classes, why not wait until week 3? If there are still spare places, you might get one from the waiting list.

Student: Is there any other option?

Director: I think you should talk to your department. If they report that you are having problems with English, we can sometimes make an exception.

Student: So if my department says I need help, I might get in?

Director: Yes. If they send a report, we can consider you even with a score over 60%.

Student: Thank you. I still hope I can join because I want to improve all three skills.

Director: I understand. For now, you are on the waiting list. We have to give priority to lower-scoring students, but if places remain, we will offer them in order of score.

Student: Thank you for explaining everything.

Director: You're welcome. I think you should contact your department as soon as possible.

R-3:

Student: Excuse me, good afternoon. I was wondering whether I could borrow some books from the library.

Librarian: Good afternoon. I appreciate your problem, but we are not lending books this week.

Student: Can I explain my problem?

Librarian: Yes, of course. Go ahead.

Student: I can see you're busy, but this is my last week of vacation before the academic year starts. Last week I finished my **pre-sessional language course**, and this week I want to work on my **preliminary reading list**. We were told that we are expected to read the main items before term starts. I'm afraid that would be too late for me if I have to wait until next week.

Librarian: I understand. But this week I am doing the annual **stocktaking**, and I'm doing it on my own because the assistant librarian is on holiday. That is why the library is only open in the afternoons, and why we decided not to lend books.

Student: Is there a rule that says I can't borrow? Or is it just for this week?

Librarian: It is just my decision for this week. But if I make one exception, then I will have to make many more. Other students may also come and say **"me too"**.

Student: I understand. I really do. But I need the books to start reading. Some of them are very expensive in the bookshops.

Librarian: Couldn't you use the main university library? It is open 9 to 5 on weekdays.

Student: I could try, but I was told that all the books on the list are here in the departmental library. And I want to start today.

Librarian: How about reading the books here in the afternoon? You can stay until 5 p.m.

Student: That would help a little, but I need more time. I read slowly because English is not my first language.

Librarian: I appreciate that. Let me think... The problem is the stocktaking. I really need the books to stay in the library this week.

Student: I understand, but even one book would help me begin.

Librarian: Well... perhaps I can lend you one book overnight. But only one, and you must bring it back tomorrow at 2 p.m. when we open.

Student: Thank you very much! That would help me a lot. I promise I will return it on time.

Librarian: All right. Choose the one you need most. But remember, this is a special exception.

Student: Of course. Thank you again for understanding.

Librarian: You're welcome. Good luck with your reading.